

The Thought of the Lord of the World

Lokeśvarakalpa · Toh 700 · Derge Kangyur

འཇག་རྟེ་དབང་ཡུ་ག་རིམ་པ།

Toh 700 in the Kangyur, known in Sanskrit as the Lokeśvara-kalpa and in Tibetan as the Jikten Wangchuk gi Tokpa, meaning The Thought of the Lord of the World, is a ritual tantra centered on Avalokiteśvara, the bodhisattva of compassion venerated as the Lord of the World. The text describes itself as a great tantra of all the buddhas, promising the fulfillment of every wish, and its opening instructions — on purifying a meditation seat, forming the lotus mudrā, and contemplating emptiness — are characteristic of the liturgical and sādhana literature of the tantric canon. It was translated into Tibetan by the monk Yeshe De and revised in accordance with the standardized terminology established during the great translation reforms. Sitting among the tantric works of the Kangyur, this text belongs to the broad category of Buddhist tantra concerned with deity yoga and mantra practice focused on a principal bodhisattva figure.

Translated by the monk Yeshe De, revised and finalized according to the new linguistic conventions.

In the Indian language: Lokeśvara-kalpa. In the Tibetan language: The Thought of the Lord of the World.

Homage to the Blessed One, the noble Avalokiteśvara, Lord of the World. Homage to the Buddha. Homage to the Dharma. Homage to the Saṅgha.

The thought of the Protector of the World
shall here be briefly set forth:
the great tantra of all the buddhas,
which bestows the fulfillment of every wish.

First, the one who holds the vidyā mantra should sit in a clean and secluded place that has been purified by the syllable HŪṂ, and, having formed the lotus mudrā, should recite: "Oṃ śūnyatā-jñāna-vajra-svabhāva-ātmako'ham" — and then contemplate all things as having the aspect of emptiness.

Following that, recite: "Oṃ citta-pratibodhāṃ karomi." Having recited this and then visualized a varicolored lotus with eight petals, one should imagine a moon disc upon the lotus. Above the moon disc, from the mantra-syllable HRĪḤ, one should visualize oneself as Avalokiteśvara, Lord of the World: seated in the posture of a bodhisattva, with two arms, reddish in color, at his side

embracing a white-robed consort, holding an open red lotus in the dancing manner, the needle-mudrā displaying the opening. One should then recite the following:

Just as the red lotus
is unstained by the fault of attachment,
so too the faults of varied habitual tendencies
are thoroughly purified within the three realms.

In the crown ornament, one should visualize Amitābha. Then recite: "Om sarva-tathāgata-kāya-vāk-citta-vajra-svabhāva-ātmako'ham."

Having thus visualized, one should then contemplate the goddess-consorts in the eight directions.

Om bilokini avalokini avalokāya svāhā. On the eastern petal, the goddess called Vilocana holds a red lotus.

Om tāre tuttāre ture svāhā. On the southern petal, the Blessed Lady Tārā holds a lotus resembling a pāśa leaf.

Om bhūriṇi mahācakravartini hūṃ. On the western petal, the goddess called Bhūriṇi holds in her hand a lotus resembling a blue utpala.

Om bhrīkuṭī-tāre-tuttama-ta hūṃ. On the northern petal, the goddess called Bhrīkuṭī holds a yellow lotus.

Om mahāśrīye maṇi-padme hūṃ. This one, the one robed in lotus garments, stands at the southeast corner and holds a lotus resembling a rose.

Om vajra-padmeśvara-mara-padme hūṃ. At the southwest corner, she holds a white lotus.

Om viśva-padme hūṃ. This one is the all-variety lotus goddess; at the northwest corner, she holds a dark lotus.

Om viśva-vaktre hūṃ. This one has manifold faces; at the northeast corner, she holds a lotus of many kinds.

Om hrīḥ padma-narteśvara hūṃ. At the center of the syllables stands the Blessed One Avalokiteśvara, Lord of the World, he of great passion.

Whoever cultivates this visualization and familiarizes themselves with meditative absorption will attain stable spiritual accomplishment. That very attainment will bestow buddhahood itself and all desired enjoyments.

The perfections of the buddhas will be accomplished,
as will dhāraṇīs and the bodhisattva grounds.
It demonstrates happiness to all the world,
each individually achieving their own realization.
Buddhahood itself is the state of the bodhisattva,
and so too is the state of the solitary buddha.
The delightful rank of buddhahood
will be attained without arduous striving.

Bodhicitta combined with camphor,
blended well with red sandalwood,
and properly joined with vajra-water —
this is the essential extract of all the buddhas.
Through this excellent practice,
the extract is obtained with ease,
under the protection of the Lord of the World:
ever youthful, free from illness, in good comfort,
with life, with strength, with diligence,
the unsurpassed gnosis of good fortune —
all of this is accomplished in this very life.
Without remainder, without exception, all is achieved:
subjugation, magnetizing, separation,
slaying, banishment, and the like,
the application of a spike and peg,
and traveling through the sky — all these likewise.

One will attain lordship over the ten grounds
and will abide in meditative absorption.
Therefore, through the vajra-samaya of one who possesses meditative
absorption,
together with the highest vidyā,
one will be fully accomplished as the Protector of the World.

Oṃ hrīḥ padma narte śvara hūṃ.

If this root mantra is recited one hundred and eight times, the non-virtues
committed during the day and night will be purified. If five hundred recitations
are performed, one will be freed from all illness. If one thousand recitations are
performed, untimely death will not occur. If two thousand recitations are
performed, one will become worthy of the offerings of all. If three thousand

recitations are performed, good fortune will arise and prosperity will increase greatly. If four thousand recitations are performed, one will be free from poverty. If five thousand recitations are performed, the hearts of all enemies will be thrown into turmoil. If six thousand recitations are performed, all enemies will be eliminated. If seven thousand recitations are performed, one will be supremely victorious over the four māras. If eight thousand recitations are performed, one will become an accomplished vidyādhara. If nine thousand recitations are performed, one will achieve accomplishment of the yakṣiṇī. If ten thousand recitations are performed, accomplishment of the daughters of gods, nāgas, and humans will be attained. If twenty thousand recitations are performed, the yoginīs who travel through the intermediate sky will be accomplished. If thirty thousand recitations are performed, all aspirations will be fulfilled. If forty thousand recitations are performed, one will attain the vidyā of moving through space. If fifty thousand recitations are performed, one will attain the vidyā of the sword. If sixty thousand recitations are performed, one will become an accomplished vidyādhara. If seventy thousand recitations are performed, one will become master of the three. If eighty thousand recitations are performed, one will become a wheel-turning king. If one hundred thousand recitations are performed, one will become a bodhisattva. If one million recitations are performed, one will take whatever form one wishes. If one million four hundred thousand recitations are performed, one will become a buddha. If ten million recitations are performed, one will be accomplished as one like the noble Avalokiteśvara, possessed of the power to take all under one's care everywhere, and body, speech, and mind will also be blessed.

This was spoken by the Blessed One with his vajra speech.

Oṃ paṇḍari vāsinī varite hūṃ.

This is the mantra of Paṇḍaravāsinī. Recited even once, it burns away the entire mass of sins of all classes. If recited aloud before a king together with his ministers within the span of seven nights, the assembled people of all destinies and the assembled queens will be brought under one's sway. By mere recitation one will come to possess the fortune of all excellence and perfection. Following this graduated sequence, if one hundred thousand recitations of this mantra are performed, one will be equal in power to all buddhas and bodhisattvas, and the noble Avalokiteśvara himself will be directly accomplished.

Oṃ vilokini avalokāya svāhā.

The application of this mantra: if ten thousand recitations are performed, the accomplishment of clearly inducing the prā vision in a mirror, on the thumbnail, in the sky, and in similar surfaces will be achieved, revealing what has occurred in the past, what is occurring in the present, and what will come in the future. Alternatively, if a tooth-cleaning stick is praised and consecrated twenty-one times —

— and if one lies down in silence at night having first used the tooth-cleaning stick without speaking, then whatever one desires will be shown in a dream, and it will be shown without error.

Oṃ tāre tuttāre ture svāhā.

The Blessed One Tārā: if this mantra is recited one hundred thousand times, the three worlds will be accomplished. Among daughters of gods, daughters of nāgas, daughters of kinnaras (half-human celestials), sons of yakṣas, and daughters of humans — whatever one desires among these — one should visualize the source of phenomena (dharmodaya) as follows: picture it painted in detail, marked with saffron, red lac, self-arisen flowers, and bodhicitta, as a deep-red six-spoked wheel, exceedingly sharp, spinning. The practitioner should visualize this source of phenomena as situated in a secret place — a mountain ravine or riverbank. It should further be meditated upon as swaying and falling upon the practitioner. One should draw it in and consider that through it wealth and prosperity have come under one's power.

Alternatively — whether a god, a nāga, an asura, a kinnara, a vidyādhara (one who holds a knowledge mantra), a yakṣa, a wheel-turning monarch, a minister, a person, or anyone else one desires — one should visualize that being very clearly in red, and vividly picture a vajra iron hook blazing with light piercing their heart with a churning hook, and a noose binding them by the neck and drawing them in, utterly intoxicated with desire. Thereby one will draw in and bring under one's power wealth along with oneself.

Oṃ bhūrini mahācakravartini hūṃ.

The application of this mantra: make a maṇḍala with great fragrant water, vajra water, and so forth, and offer flowers of whatever kind are available as a complete offering. The practitioner dwelling there should recite while visualizing being the sovereign of an island, or another island, or a city, a town, or a district. Through this one will become the master thereof, and

having enjoyed all its wealth and pleasures, one will attain birth in the world-realm of Sukhāvatī.

Oṃ bhṛkuṭī tāre tutama ta hūṃ.

This goddess called Bhṛkuṭī (the Frowning One): take dust from an enemy's footprint; blend it with poison, salt, kēśa plant, blood, soil from both banks of a river, and great fragrant vajra water; make an effigy from this; pierce all the joints and vital points with a peg made from human bone; place it inside two skulls sealed face to face; and burn it in a cremation-ground fire. If the rite is performed for seven days the enemy will die. If however the practitioner's own mind is free of evil, then in twenty-one days even a buddha would die.

Oṃ mahāśrīye maṇipadme hūṃ.

If this goddess is individually venerated with fragrance, flowers, lamps, and alms food, and the mantra is recited, one will be protected in all circumstances. One will triumph over local Dharma disputes. One will become equal to Avalokiteśvara. One will become the master of great wealth. Alternatively, if a fire-offering of ten thousand lotus flowers is performed, one will become a king.

Oṃ vajrapadmeśvarī mara padme hūṃ.

This Vajra-Lotus Sovereign Lady: if recited mentally, she performs subjugation, magnetizing, and so forth. If praised seven times and one's topknot is knotted, one will be self-protected, and epidemic disease, hidden illness, all illness, weapons, fire, thieves, lions, elephants, snakes, imprisonment, the ocean, and the cannibal disease — all of these will be pacified by one thousand recitations. Through the activity of a single recitation, the spirit of forgetfulness, the spirit of wasting away, vomiting, difficulty in excretion —

all malicious sentient beings who are difficult to tame will be defeated. Through one hundred thousand recitations, the body flourishes and good fortune arises; the body becomes youthful and free from illness, and untimely death is averted. Alternatively, one may draw this in a nāga hearth-pit and there perform a fire offering with poison, long-pepper, and heating substances, combining them with the name of the nāga. If one hundred thousand such fire offerings are performed, great rains will fall and famine will be no more.

Oṃ viśvapadme hrīḥ. The Varied Lotus: this mantra dispels dullness, arrogance, oppression, and stabbing with a peg; it takes away the wealth of others, works with the peg, creates optical illusions and wonders, brings about

invisibility, enables entry into hidden caverns, enables travel through the sky, cuts iron chains, and draws things together into a ball — whatever activities of this kind are taught in the tantras, and all activities that accord with other tantras as well, it performs. It bestows accomplishments (siddhis) of body, speech, and mind. The Blessed One, noble Avalokiteśvara, is accomplished, and all activities whatsoever that one desires will be achieved. This is what is said.

Oṃ viśvapadme hūṃ. The goddess called Varied Vajra bestows the accomplishment of speech. She makes one skilled in cutting through words, and makes the speech of others falter. She will protect oneself and will protect others as well. She brings good fortune to oneself and good fortune to others, accomplishing one's own benefit and the benefit of others. Just as noble Avalokiteśvara here delights and strives for the welfare of sentient beings, so too the Blessed One herself liberates sentient beings dwelling in the realms of hell-beings, hungry ghosts, and animals. To those who have faith in the teaching of the Sugata, she protects them as a mother. Thus spoke the Tathāgata, the vajra of mind.

In this way, the royal compendium of understanding has been fully taught.

One of stable mind, free of discursive thought,
endowed with intelligence, will attain accomplishment.
Just as all the buddhas have traversed
the path of conduct that is taught here,
by applying it in the same way in this very life,
the permanent state of liberation will be achieved.

Abiding in accord with whatever one desires,
as though fulfilling every enjoyment for all,
acting with whatever compassion one wishes,
through whatever conduct one desires —
whether seated or standing,
walking, or however it may be,
laughing, speaking —
whatever it is, exactly as it is, it is as it truly is.

Even one who has not entered the maṇḍala,
or who is laden with every obscuration,
even a yoga master of meager merit
who relies devotedly on the deity —

through this, one will attain in this very life
the state of being all the buddhas,
the state of omniscient wisdom itself,
and even the state of Vajradhara.

Furthermore it is said:

Yogins are not transformed from the reflected image
of a fabricated form body.

If one strives in the great awakening mind,
that is what yogins truly are.

Great blood together with camphor,
blended with red sandalwood —
when one enters into the gaṇacakra assembly,
it is the supreme extract-essence surpassing all.

Through this excellent preparation,
the taking of the life-essence becomes easy.
One will obtain the fine longevity of the glorious Vajrasattva,
freedom from illness, and supreme well-being.

As the defining marks of accomplishment have been taught,
the perfections of the buddhas,
dhāraṇīs, and the grounds alike are accomplished in the same way;
all displays of bliss will be obtained,
and each will be accomplished individually in succession.

Through union with all the buddhas,
one will become all the buddhas themselves.
The very essence of all the buddhas,
all the buddhas, is supremely accomplished.

Furthermore, for one who wishes to engage in yogic conduct but does not
possess a fully purified mind, the accomplishment of the clay effigy is then
explained.

One who observes the eight precepts of a lay retreat and is engaged in fasting
should paint the image of the deity on fresh cloth of unmixed colors, the image
being measured in each case at one cubit length according to one's own
measure. Upon this cloth, the Blessed One, the noble Avalokiteśvara, is to be
painted as follows.

A multicolored lotus with eight petals, with a moon-disc maṇḍala at the center of the stamen whorl, upon which stands the Blessed One, red in color, bearing the crown of Akṣobhya. He has three faces: his principal face is red, signifying great attachment; his right face is dark, signifying great aversion; his left face is white, signifying delusion. He has six arms. With one left hand he embraces at the neck a woman clad in white garments; another left hand holds a red lotus; with the remaining left hand he holds a flower-bow. Among his three right hands, one bears the mudrā of a lotus opening by a needle, another holds a flower-arrow, and another holds an iron hook. He sits in the cross-legged posture of a bodhisattva.

On the eastern petal is the goddess Pāṇḍaravāsini, white in color, holding a red lotus and a vajra in her hands. On the southern petal is the goddess Tārā, green in color, holding in her hands a leaf of the red-sandalwood tree and a jewel. On the western petal is Bhūriṇī, yellow in color, holding a blue utpala lotus and a wheel in her hands. On the northern petal is Bhrūkuṭī, of a color like a white-and-gold lotus, holding a yellow lotus and a sword in her hands.

In the southeastern corner is Padmavāsini, of golden hue, holding a lotus like one tinged with madder dye. In the southwestern corner is Vajrapadmeśvarī, sky-blue and white in color, holding a lotus and a crystal rosary. In the northwestern corner stands one who displays the multicolored lotus, white-gold in color like an autumn moon, holding a black lotus and a book in her hands. In the northeastern corner is Viśvavajrā, rendered in multicolored hues, holding a multicolored vajra and a multicolored lotus.

Having arranged and painted the deities on the lotus in this way, the Graceful One and the others are placed in the corners. The hook, the lasso, the chain, and the bell, arising from the syllables Jaḥ, Hūṃ, Baṃ, Hoḥ, are placed in the directions beginning with the east.

Now another form of the painted image is described. The Blessed One is white-gold in color, like an autumn moon. In his right hands he holds a thread, a staff, a trident, and makes the gesture of granting the supreme gift. In his left hands he holds a lotus, a vase for pouring over the head, a lasso, and a scriptural volume representing the pledge of omniscience. He wears a lower garment of tiger skin. He holds a serpent as an offering vessel in his hand. In his knotted crown-hair is set an image of Amitābha either standing or seated in the half-cross-legged posture, serving as his crown ornament. To the right of this form stands the sādḥaka, the practitioner, holding in hand a water-offering

vessel and a vessel for burning incense.

Furthermore, there is another form of the Blessed One: two-handed, dwelling in the triangular posture, seated on a lion throne. His left hand rests on the ground; his right foot is set upon a lotus cushion upon the lotus. In each of his hands he is conceived as holding a rosary, and the manner of this conception, in which the meditator draws downward below the rosary, is called dwelling in the manner of the meditating mind.

Yet another rite prescribes the Blessed One as white with a reddish tinge, with ten hands, seated in the half-cross-legged posture upon a lotus placed upon the seat of deer and lions. In his right hands he holds a rosary. He has the appearance of one who liberates from the terrors of lions, elephants, fire, and serpents. In his left hands he holds two red lotus stalks upon which rests a book, and he has the appearance of one who liberates from the terrors of thieves, bondage in iron chains, the ocean, great thunderbolts, and those who eat flesh.

In eight positions around this image stands the sādḥaka, adorned with all ornaments,

with all limbs perfectly complete, standing as before, or sitting — so one should visualize.

Furthermore, the ritual procedure is as follows. In the center of a lunar maṇḍala, the Blessed One holds a form of many aspects, with thirteen heads. The topmost head is that of a green horse-face. Alternatively, it may be the peaceful face of the Buddha Śākyamuni. This Blessed One of a hundred hands bears various weapons. Alternatively, one may depict a hundred faces and a thousand hands. In some versions he is seated in the vajra cross-legged posture, or standing. The Blessed One is white-yellow in color, like the campaka flower.

To the right side of all these painted images, the sādḥaka holds in his hands flowers, a vessel of water offering, and a vessel of incense. Upon the heads of these figures, Amitābha or a stūpa of the Dharma King is to be painted as the crown ornament. This is the ritual of the painted image.

Before the painted image, one recites the root mantra as many times as desired and performs meditative concentration. One then makes offering with five kinds of offering: a vessel of water offering, food like nectar filling it to the brim, and offering made from the flame of a lamp — presenting the water

offering and reciting whatever mantra one wishes. By doing so, one will obtain the accomplishments (Skt. *siddhi*) spoken of in relation to it.

This mantra is secret.

It is not given to just anyone.

It is to be given to the wise sentient being
who strives for the benefit of others
and whose mind is steady.

To the one who performs the work of stūpas,
it is to be given by the wise with effort.

With one's own self and one's own wealth,
always show reverence to the lama.

To the vajra master (Skt. vajrācārya) and the yogin,
also offer the highest honorarium.

Whatever is most difficult to give away,
giving that is here praised as supremely excellent.

Wives, sisters,
daughters, and granddaughters —
adorn the daughters with all ornaments.

Elephants, horses, chariots,
livestock, cities, kingdoms,
districts endowed with dominion,
and also various precious things —
all of these too are to be offered to the vajra master.

When the vajra master is pleased,
all should be given generously as offering.

Here ends the contemplation of the Lord of the World.

Translated from the Sanskrit by the Indian paṇḍita Jambhala and the Tibetan...

Translator's Notes

- The text contains ritual Sanskrit mantras that are reproduced transliterated as they appear; their precise Sanskrit orthography in the original is sometimes non-standard, and they are kept here as encountered.

The phrase rendered "he of great passion" for the Avalokiteśvara at the center of the maṇḍala reflects the Tibetan "འབྲས་ལོག་པའི་ཐུགས་རྒྱལ་པོ།," literally "the Blessed Avalokiteśvara, Lord of Great Desire." This is a tantric epithet of Avalokiteśvara in his passionate or erotic-transcendent aspect, common in certain ritual cycles; it is not a moral claim about ordinary desire.

The goddess described as holding a "pāśa leaf" lotus at the southern petal likely involves a corrupt or abbreviated term; the leaf comparison may refer to a particular lotus variety associated with Tārā's iconography.

The text breaks off mid-sentence at the end of the passage.

- The phrase "master of the three" for རྩ་མཁན་གསུམ་ཀློང་པོ་ is ambiguous — the "three" could refer to the three worlds, the three realms, or the three times. Given the tantric context and the graduated scale of attainments leading up to wheel-turning kingship, "three worlds" is most likely, but the text gives no explicit gloss.

The term "prā vision" renders the Tibetan transcription of Sanskrit prā or pradarśana, a technical term for a clairvoyant vision induced in a reflective surface. The Tibetan དཔྱལ་ (pra) is a loanword for this divinatory technique; it is left in abbreviated transliteration as conventional in this literature.

- The term rendered "source of phenomena" is dharmodaya (Tib. chos-'byung), a triangular or other symbolic form used in tantric ritual contexts, here described as a red six-spoked wheel — the two usages appear conflated or combined in the text, which is not unusual in this genre of ritual compendium.

The phrase "even a buddha would die" is a conventional hyperbolic intensifier in tantric cursing rites, signifying the absolute potency of the rite when the practitioner is pure; it is not a doctrinal claim about buddhas being subject to death.

- The phrase rendered "the state of being all the buddhas" and "the state of Vajradhara" follows the Vajrayāna doctrinal claim that tantric practice can yield full buddhahood, identified with Vajradhara, within a single lifetime. The verse structure in the original is somewhat loose and the syntax of several lines is compressed; the translation follows the most doctrinally coherent reading throughout.

The term "gaṇacakra assembly" renders གཤམ་ཆུ་མཚའ་ཁྲིའི་ཆུ་མཚའ་ཁྲིའི་ཆུ་མཚའ་, literally "when entering into the assembly feast," referring to the tantric gaṇacakra ritual gathering.

The final line introduces "accomplishment of the clay effigy" (འཕྲུལ་པ་ལྷ་མོ་འབྲུག་པ་), a practice involving painted or molded clay images; this appears to be a transition to a new sub-section of the text.

- The passage describes a complex sādhana iconographic description, likely from a ritual manual related to Avalokiteśvara. The term Bhūriṇī in the western petal and the figure whose name is transliterated from the Tibetan bhu ri ni are not perfectly attested Sanskrit names; the Tibetan rendering is followed as given. The "goddess who displays the multicolored lotus" in the northwestern corner is a descriptive rendering rather than a fixed proper name, as the Tibetan gives a description rather than a clear name. The "triangular posture" renders ri gru 'dzin, a hand gesture or bodily posture whose precise technical description is uncertain; it may refer to a triangular hand position or a posture name.
 - The phrase rendered "Lord of the World" at the colophon translates Lokeśvara, an epithet of Avalokiteśvara, and the section-closing formula indicates this is the conclusion of a discrete chapter or sādhana text devoted to him. The colophon is incomplete as given, breaking off mid-sentence after naming the Indian paṇḍita Jambhala and indicating a Tibetan collaborator whose name does not appear in the supplied text. The campaka flower is a fragrant yellow-white South Asian bloom commonly used in Sanskrit literary similes for complexion. The phrase rendered "various weapons" for the hundred-handed form reflects the standard iconographic description of Sahasrabhuja Avalokiteśvara in certain traditions where the hands bear implements; the precise list is not enumerated in this passage.
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Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.